Count Dracula

By Woody Allen

NARRATOR: **(Pg 238-244)** Somewhere in Transylvania, Dracula the monster is sleeping in his coffin, waiting for night to fall. As exposure to the sun's rays would surely cause him to perish, he stays protected in the satin-lined chamber bearing his family name in silver. Then the moment of darkness comes, and through some miraculous instinct the fiend emerges from the safety of his hiding place and, assuming the hideous forms of the bat or the wolf, he prowls the countryside, drinking the blood of his victims. Finally, before the first rays of his archenemy, the sun, announce a new day, he hurries back to the safety of his hidden coffin and sleeps, as the cycle begins anew.

INTRODUCTION

Now and then, everybody has a bad day. I bet even Mother Theresa felt cross sometimes. It happens to everyone. You know you're having a bad day when . . .

- *You call your wife and tell her that you would like to eat out tonight and when you get home there is a sandwich on the front porch.*

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- *Your 4-year-old tells you that it's almost impossible to flush a grapefruit down the toilet.*
- *Today's the day of the total eclipse, and no one reminded you . . . What's wrong with that you ask? Nothing unless you are*

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NARRATOR: *(simultaneously pantomime the narration as Dracula)* Now he starts to stir. The fluttering of his eyelids are a response to some age-old, unexplainable instinct that the sun is nearly down and his time is near. Tonight, he is particularly hungry as he lies there, fully awake now, in red-lined Inverness cape and tails, waiting to feel with uncanny perception the precise moment of darkness before opening the lid and emerging, he decides who this evening's victims will be. The baker and his wife, he thinks to himself. Succulent, available, and unsuspecting. The thought of the unwary couple whose trust he has carefully cultivated excites his blood lust to a fever pitch, and he can barely hold back these last seconds before climbing out of the coffin to seek his prey.

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Suddenly he knows the sun is down. Like an angel of hell, he rises swiftly, and changing into a bat, flies pell-mell to the cottage of his tantalizing victims.

BAKER'S WIFE: *(opening the door)* Why, Count Dracula, what a nice surprise.

NARRATOR: He has once again assumed human form, charmingly concealing his rapacious goal.

BAKER: What brings you here so early?

DRACULA: Our dinner date. I hope I haven't made an error. You did invite for tonight, didn't you?

BAKER: Yes, tonight, but that's not for seven hours.

DRACULA: *(looking around the room puzzled)* Pardon me?

BAKER: Or did you come to watch the eclipse with us?

DRACULA: Eclipse?

BAKER: Yes. Today's the total eclipse.

DRACULA: What?

BAKER: A few moments of darkness from noon until two minutes after. Look out the window.

DRACULA: *(with rising panic that he tries to mask)* Uh-oh. I'm in big trouble.

BAKER: Eh?

DRACULA: And now if you'll excuse me . . .

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BAKER: What, Count Dracula?

DRACULA: *(Frantically fumbling for the doorknob)* Must be going-aha-oh god . . .

BAKER: Going? You just came.

DRACULA: Yes-but-I think I blew it very badly . . .

BAKER: Count Dracula, you're pale.

DRACULA: Am I? I need a little fresh air. It was nice seeing you . .

BAKER: Come. Sit down. We'll have a drink.

DRACULA: Drink? No, I must run. Er-you're stepping on my cape.

BAKER: Sure. Relax. Some wine.

DRACULA: Wine? Oh no, gave it up-liver and all that, you know. And now I really must buzz off. I just remembered, I left the lights on in the castle -- bills'll be enormous. . .

BAKER: *(putting his arm around the Count in friendship)* You're not intruding. Don't be so polite. So you're early.

DRACULA: Really, I'd like to stay but there's a meeting of old Romanian counts across town and I'm responsible for the cold cuts.

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BAKER: Rush, rush, rush. It's a wonder you don't get a heart attack.

DRACULA: Yes, right-and now-

BAKER'S WIFE: I'm making chicken pilaf tonight. I hope you like it.

DRACULA: *(smiling and pushing her aside)* Wonderful, wonderful. *(opens a closet door by mistake and walks in)* Christ. Where's the front door?

BAKER'S WIFE: *(laughing)* Ach, such a funny man, the count.

DRACULA: *(forcing a chuckle)* I knew you'd like that. Now get out of my way. *(opens the front door and panics at the sunlight)*

BAKER: Oh, look, the eclipse must be over. The sun is coming out again.

DRACULA: *(slamming the front door)* Right. I've decided to stay. Pull down the window shades quickly-quickly! Let's move it!

BAKER: What window shades?

DRACULA: There are none, right? Figures. You got a basement?

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BAKER'S WIFE: *(affably)* No, I'm always telling Jarslov to build one but he never listens. That's some husband, my Jarslov.

DRACULA: I'm all choked up. Where's the closet?

BAKER: You did that one already, Count Dracula. Unt mama and I laughed at it.

BAKER'S WIFE: Ach-such a funny man, the Count.

DRACULA: Look, I'll be in the closet. Knock at seven-thirty. *(he steps in the closet and slams the door)*

BAKER'S WIFE: Hee-hee--he is so funny, Jarslov.

BAKER: Oh, count. Come out of the closet. Stop being a big silly.

DRACULA: *(from inside the closet comes the muffled voice of Dracula)* Can't. Please. Take my word for it. Just let me stay here. I'm fine. Really.

BAKER: Count Dracula, stop the fooling. We're already helpless with laughter.

DRACULA: Can I tell you, I love this closet.

BAKER: Yes, but . . .

DRACULA: I know, I know . . . It seems strange, and yet here I am, having a ball. I was just saying to Mrs. Hess the other day, give me a good closet and I can stand in

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it for hours. Sweet woman, Mrs. Hess. Fat, but sweet . . . Now, why don't you run along and check back with me at sunset.

NARRATOR: Now the mayor and his wife, Katia, arrive. They are passing by and have decided to pay a call on their good friends, the baker and his wife.

MAYOR: Hello, Jarslov. I hope Katia and I are not intruding?

BAKER: Of course not, Mr. Mayor. Come out, Count Dracula. We have company!

MAYOR: *(surprised)* Is the count here?

BAKER'S WIFE: Yes, and you'll never guess where.

MAYOR: It's so rare to see him around this early. In fact, I can't ever remember seeing him around in the daytime.

BAKER'S WIFE: Well, he's here. Come out, Count Dracula!

KATIA: Where is he?

BAKER'S WIFE: *(impatiently)* Come on out now! Let's go!

BAKER: *(apologetically)* He's in the closet. (knocking on the door) Let's go. Enough is enough. The mayor's here.

MAYOR: Come on out, Dracula. Let's have a drink.

DRACULA: No, go ahead. I have business in here.

MAYOR: In the closet?

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DRACULA: Yes, don't let me spoil your day. I can hear what you're saying. I'll join in if I have anything to add.

NARRATOR: Everyone looks at one another and shrugs. Wine is poured and they all drink.

MAYOR: Some eclipse today.

BAKER: Yes. Incredible.

DRACULA: Yeah. Thrilling.

BAKER: What, Dracula?

DRACULA: Nothing, nothing. Let it go.

NARRATOR: And so some time passes, until the mayor can stand it no longer.

MAYOR: (forcing open the door to the closet, he shouts) Come on, Dracula. I always thought you were a mature man. Stop this craziness.

NARRATOR: The daylight streams in, causing the evil monster to shriek and slowly dissolve to a skeleton and then to dust before the eyes of the people present.

MAYOR: *(Leaning down to the pile of white ash on the closet floor)* Does this mean dinner is cancelled?

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AWARD HISTORY

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